

2. Good writing skills make you more desirable to employers

In many instances, the first impression you make on a potential employer is in a cover letter or résumé. An interesting and well-written cover letter could potentially lead to an interview and eventually a job.

Even when you do not have a formal cover letter, there are often many email exchanges during an interview process. Emails that are clearly written generally makes you seem more intelligent and responsible to a potential employer.

Personally, I know that my ability to write coherent emails has given me an edge in finding software engineering jobs, because most software engineers are not taught to write properly.

3. It is a cheap hobby

Writing is probably one of the cheapest hobbies out there. You do not need expensive materials or equipment; you can start with a plain notebook and pencil. Writing can also take up quite a bit of time, so you could be entertained for hours by your own imagination and creativity.

4. Well-written content has monetary value

Many people make a living through writing. For example, even in a soft-

ware company we have copywriters and technical writers. The ability to communicate useful information is worth its weight in gold. Even if you are not a professional writer, it is possible to start a blog and earn a bit of side income because there is an endless amount of content on the Internet, and good content is rare.

Writing is a skill that can be learned and improved. You can take a class at a local college that teaches you to write, or just read articles and books about the art of writing. Another great thing is that you can practice it anywhere and any way you want.

I think it is unfortunate that proper writing is not emphasized in this highly technical world. And even though we have mainstream journalists that publish phrases like “We wuz robbed,” I believe that being able to communicate effectively through language will always be valued. — **Xin Lu**

